CITY OF OAKWOOD
STATE OF OHIO
JUNE 1, 2026

The Council of the City of Oakwood, State of Ohio, met in a work session at 6:30 p.m. in the conference room of the City of Oakwood, 30 Park Avenue, Oakwood, Ohio 45419. Council then met in a regular session at 7:30 p.m. in the council chambers of the City of Oakwood.

The meeting was streamed live on the Oakwood city website and broadcast on Cable Access Channel 6.

The Vice Mayor, Mr. Steve Byington, presided, and the Clerk, Ms. Lori Stacel, recorded. Vice Mayor Byington asked all present to participate in the Pledge of Allegiance.

Upon call of the roll, the following members of Council responded to their names:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....ABSENT
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....PRESENT
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....PRESENT
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....PRESENT
MR. SAM DORF.....PRESENT

Officers of the City present were the following:

Mrs. Katie Smiddy, City Manager
Mr. Robert F. Jacques, City Attorney
Ms. Lori Stacel, Clerk of Council

The following visitors registered:

Nate Mundy, Montgomery County Recorder's Office
Kate Furmanski, Oakwood Inclusion Coalition
Karen Bartley, Oakwood Historical Society
Kathryn Secrest, AES
Ohio State Representative Andrea White
Beth Byington, 24 W. Schantz Avenue
Brian Barr, *Oakwood Register*

It was moved by Mr. Dorf and seconded by Mrs. Turben that the absence of Mayor Duncan be excused. Upon a viva voce vote on the question of the motion, same passed unanimously and it was so ordered.

Mr. Dorf advised Council he had read the meeting minutes of the May 4, 2026, regular session and work session, and the May 18, 2026 work session and executive session. Mr. Dorf reported that he found the minutes to be correct and complete. Therefore, it was moved by Mr. Dorf and seconded by Mrs. Turben that the minutes of the sessions of Council aforementioned be approved as written and the reading thereof at this session be dispensed with. Upon a viva voce vote on the question of the motion, same passed unanimously, and it was so ordered.

STATUS REPORTS

Citizen Committee Appointment – Vice Mayor Byington presented the appointment of Kevin Brooks to the Beautification Committee and Iris Juergens to the Board of Zoning Appeals.

It was moved by Vice Mayor Byington and seconded by Mrs. Turben the appointment be confirmed. Upon a viva vote on the question of the motion, the same passed unanimously, and it was so ordered.

VISITORS

Montgomery County Recorder's Office Update: Nate Mundy, External Communications Manager for the Montgomery County Recorder's Office, provided an overview of the programs and services offered by the Recorder's Office. He highlighted resources available to property owners, including the Fraud Alert Notification (FAN) System, which helps residents monitor potential fraudulent activity involving property records. Mr. Mundy also discussed Transfer on Death designations and programs available to veterans. In response to a question from Councilmember Jackson, Mr. Mundy encouraged residents to enroll in the FAN System and noted that additional information is available on the Recorder's Office website.

Oakwood Inclusion Coalition (OIC) 2025 Annual Report: Kate Furmanski, a member of the OIC, presented the organization's 2025 Annual Report. She highlighted the OIC's ongoing efforts to promote inclusion through community engagement, educational programming, and partnerships with the City of Oakwood, Oakwood City Schools, and Wright Memorial Public Library. Notable accomplishments included hosting public events and film screenings, launching the OIC's first

 podcast, supporting the City's implementation of the Blue Envelope Program, expanding community outreach through newsletters and local events, and planning for the upcoming Longest Table community gathering. Ms. Furmanski also reported on additions to the organization's leadership team, continued financial stability, and increased fundraising support.

Councilmember Jackson commended the OIC for its monthly newsletter, noting that it helps residents learn more about one another and contributes positively to the community. Councilmember Dorf remarked on the impressive amount of work and dedication that continues to be invested in the organization's efforts. Vice Mayor Byington praised the OIC's extensive mailing list and wide variety of events, commenting that he frequently learns about opportunities and community activities through the organization's communications. He also expressed appreciation for the OIC's willingness to listen to community members and foster meaningful dialogue.

State Legislative Update: State Representative Andrea White addressed Council regarding several legislative matters currently under consideration at the Statehouse. She reported that the state budget bill had been introduced and includes a recommended $450,000 allocation for Oakwood's Shafor and Orchardly Parks renovation project. Representative White noted that both the House and Senate are expected to vote on the funding measure on June 10.

Representative White also provided an update on proposed e-bike legislation, discussing efforts to increase public awareness, promote safety education, and explore driver training requirements. She commended Councilmembers Turben and Dorf for their leadership and collaborative work with Council in addressing e-bike safety concerns and helping advance the conversation at the state level.

Mrs. Turben thanked Representative White for her guidance and support.

Oakwood Historical Society Update: Karen Bartley of the Oakwood Historical Society provided an update on the organization's activities. She noted that the Long-Romspert Homestead is open for tours on Sundays from 1:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m., with additional tours available by appointment. Ms. Bartley also highlighted ongoing programs, including Century Home markers awarded to homes 100 years of age or older and plans for a historical marker recognizing Hawthorn Hill.

Mrs. Turben encouraged residents to follow the Oakwood Historical Society on Facebook, noting that the organization regularly shares interesting facts and stories about the community's history. Vice Mayor Byington commended the Historical Society for its research efforts and the valuable work it does documenting the history of Oakwood homes.

LEGISLATION

A RESOLUTION
BY VICE MAYOR BYINGTON NO 1951
A RESOLUTION PROVIDING FOR AN ELECTION ON THE QUESTION OF A RENEWAL TAX LEVY IN EXCESS OF THE TEN-MILL LIMITATION FOR CURRENT EXPENSES AND THE GENERAL OPERATION OF THE CITY.

A copy of the resolution, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

Vice Mayor Byington explained the City has an existing 2.72 mill property tax levy that is due to expire at the end of 2026. The 2.72 mill levy was first approved by Oakwood voters in 1991 and has been renewed every five years since then. At the May meeting, Council took the first legislative step to put this matter on the ballot for renewal, and this resolution is the second and final step. It is important to note that since this is a renewal instead of a new levy, it will maintain the current level of property taxation and will not increase property taxes.

Thereupon, it was moved by Vice Mayor Byington and seconded by Mr. Dorf that the resolution be passed.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. STEVEN BYINGTON .....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN .....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF .....YEA

There being four (4) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said resolution was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

CITY MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

Mrs. Smiddy reported that the City's communications survey has been extended through the end of the month to provide additional residents with an opportunity to participate and share their preferences for receiving City communications.

She also reported that, despite less-than-ideal weather conditions, the Oakwood Pool welcomed approximately 600 visitors during opening weekend. To date, approximately 650 pool memberships have been sold, generating $164,000 in revenue.

Mrs. Smiddy noted that Oakwood Public Safety Department lieutenants and public safety officers recently participated in the Law Enforcement Torch Run, raising awareness and support for Special Olympics Ohio.

Finally, Mrs. Smiddy reported that bids for the City's 2026 asphalt paving program had been received. Staff is recommending award of the contract to John R. Jurgensen Company, whose bid came in below the engineer's estimate, resulting in favorable pricing for the City.

COUNCIL COMMENTS

Mr. Dorf recognized Oakwood resident Lily Rodriguez for her outstanding accomplishments in competitive para rowing, noting that she set 18 indoor world records and recently competed in the Dogwood Junior Championship Regatta. He also highlighted a feature story about Lily that appeared in *Oakwood Register* and noted that she had been selected to continue her rowing career in Sarasota, Florida, before attending Marietta College this fall. Mr. Dorf also acknowledged the beginning of Pride Month, sharing that he is a member of the LGBTQ+ community and extending well wishes to all who are celebrating. He stated that Pride Month provides an opportunity for individuals to be seen and celebrate their authentic selves and invited residents to attend the Oakwood Family Pride Picnic at Shafor Park.

Mrs. Jackson congratulated the Oakwood High School Class of 2026 and wished graduates success in their future endeavors. She encouraged them to serve as positive ambassadors for the city wherever their paths may lead. Mrs. Jackson also encouraged residents to visit the Oakwood Historical Society Museum and recognized the volunteers who helped operate the museum. In addition, she promoted the Oakwood Inclusion Coalition's Longest Table event and encouraged residents to participate. She also reminded residents to enroll in the Montgomery County property fraud notification system as a proactive measure to protect their property records.

Mrs. Turben noted that Oakwood continues to be one of the safest communities in the region, with one of the lowest crime rates. She reported that the Public Safety Department's Facebook page, established last year, has been an effective tool for sharing news, safety information, and department updates with residents. She highlighted a current series of posts focused on e-bike safety and reminded residents of the importance of securing their vehicles. Mrs. Turben noted that recent vehicle thefts in Oakwood involved unlocked vehicles with keys left inside and encouraged residents to lock their vehicles and remove keys when not in use. She also encouraged residents to follow the Public Safety Department on Facebook for additional information and updates.

Vice Mayor Byington thanked the residents who attended the meeting and noted that public participation and shared information help Council make informed decisions and better serve the community. He also thanked the members of the Oakwood Rotary Club and other volunteers who displayed American flags along Shafor Boulevard over the Memorial Day weekend. Vice Mayor Byington acknowledged Pride Month and encouraged residents to recognize and celebrate the month within the community.

The public meeting concluded at 8:21 p.m.

William D Dorf

MAYOR

ATTEST:

Yori Vocal

CLERK OF COUNCIL